

Once you push a new browser, it will take some time, may be even years, for it to represent a majority of internet users. Even now, there are people using Firefox 1.5 or Internet Explorer 6.

Even standards take time to sink in, because despite the latest browsers claiming to be fully standards-compliant (which they are not), we still have the problem that everyone will not have the latest browser.

So between programming across different browsers, and taking into account the different versions of those browsers, your code can become very complicated and bulky if you want to make it work for everyone. You must also ensure that a user using a browser that doesn't support JavaScript or one in which JavaScript is disabled, is not left stranded.

4.3 Basic JavaScript

JavaScript can be placed anywhere in your HTML document as long as it is enclosed within a `<script>` tag, which can be placed anywhere within the body, or in the header. If the code needs to be reused, it can also be placed in an external file which is referenced in the document, via the `<script>` tag's 'src' property. Since the header of the document is loaded before the page starts displaying, placing the script in the header ensures that it is loaded before the page can call to any functions defined in it.

If any of you have used C, C++ or a similar language, you will find the syntax quite similar. The structure of the code is represented in pretty much the same way. The following is an example of some JavaScript code that takes two numbers, and finds the highest, lowest and average of the numbers using functions.

```
var a = 5;
var b = 16;
var greater = greaterof(a, b);
var lower = smallerof(a, b);
var average = averageof(a, b);

function greaterof(num1, num2){
    return num1 > num2 ? num1 : num2;
```